

User Manual

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Contents

1 introduction

1.1 Idea

Teaching materials come in many forms and versions, such as lecture notes, slides, or handouts, and may be available in different languages. Yet the content is often the same or similar, and the structures—for example, the order of the teaching and learning units—should be consistent. In other words: The same thing (here semantic information) should appear in different forms. In computer science or chemistry, this concept is also known as *polymorphism*¹

At the same time, teaching materials are generally revised on an ongoing basis. Individual teaching units are updated, reorganized, or removed entirely, while new ones are added. Maintaining the desired consistency throughout this process is difficult. The [OSG Lecture Bundle](#) aims to support instructors in this effort. It is based on a central idea:

Redundancies should be kept to a **minimum**.

Where redundancies are necessary (for example, with different versions of a text), it is easier to maintain consistency if related source material is located as **close together** as possible.

Therefore, [OSG Lecture](#) is intended, amongst other things, to enable:

- Generating different types of documents from the same source;
- easy reorganization of teaching units;
- different language versions from the same source, wherein shared data does not need to be presented redundantly;
- support for creating and revising individual instructional units that can be easily integrated (e.g., lecture notes chapters into a comprehensive set of lecture notes);
- rapid deployment of the various types of document.

This was based on the procedures and workflows that are currently standard practice at the Operating Systems Group at Chemnitz University of Technology. If you do not work there and, for example, have different procedures, [OSG Lecture](#) might still be useful to you: individual packages within the bundle can also be used independently of the others.

¹Perhaps *poly-representation* or even *multimodality* would be even more appropriate terms, but the former isn't very well established, and with the latter, I'd probably have to discuss with cultural studies scholars and semioticians whether different languages should be understood as *modes*. Besides, I'm a computer scientist, so polymorphism seems like a natural choice.